AD EMUM P. D. IOANNEM, TITULO SANCTAE MARIAE TRANS TIBERIM, S. R. E. PRESB. CARD. TACCI, SACRAE CONGREGATIONIS PRO ECCLESIA ORIENTALI SECRETARIUM, QUEM LEGATUM MITTIT CONSTANTIAM SOLLEMNIBUS IN HONOREM SANCTAE MARIAE MAGDALENAE POSTEL CELEBRANDIS.

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Dilecte fili Noster, salutem et apostolicam benedictionem. — S t a t i a d e s s e properant dies, c u m i n h o n o r e m Mariae M a g d a l e n a e P o s t e l , q u a m i n s a n c t o r u m c a e l i t u m n u m e r u m h a u d i t a m u l t o a n t e r e t t u l i m u s , sacra h a b e b u n t u r sollemnia in p e r v e t u s t a illa Servatoris Christi A b b a t i a , q u a e , s a n c t a e novensilis cura, per i m p e d i m e n t a o m n e g e n u s , refecta e t princeps Congregationis d o m u s c o n s t i t u t a , ipsius Matris legiferae u t v i d e t u r olere a d h u c v i r t u t e s , sic v e n e r a b i l e corpus e t a l u m n a r u m e t christiani p o p u l i p i e t a t i c u s t o d i t . E i u s m o d i q u i d e m sollemnibus - q u o r u m f r u c t u o s a a c t i o n o n erit profecto ab a m p h s s i m i s civilis l a e t i t i a e significationibus disiuncta - d e c e t o m n i n o t e , dilecte f i l i N o s t e r , q u o I n s t i t u t u m S c h o l a r u m Christia- n a r u m a Misericordia p a t r o n o a p u d A p o s t o l i c a m S e d e m utitur, n o n t a m interesse q u a m praeesse e t n o b i h s s i m a r u m a n i m i t u i l a u d u m r o m a n a e q u e p u r p u r a e s p l e n d o r e m adiicere. V e r u m , q u o n i a m t a n t a m h u i u s rei f a u s t i t a - t e m N o s m e t praecipuo q u o d a m m o d o participare v o l u m u s , t e , dilecte f i l i N o - ster, n o m i n e q u o q u e a c d i g n i t a t e L e g a t i N o s t r i a u g e m u s a t q u e o r n a m u s , u t N o s t r a m per e a s o l l e m n i a p e r s o n a m rite sustineas. Q u o d q u i d e m consilium idcirco inire p l a c u i t , quia Mariae M a g d a l e n a e P o s t e l eo ampliores in l u c e p a t r i a e s u a e honores deferendi v i d e b a n t u r , q u o submissiore i p s a a n i m o , u s q u e a d e x t r e m u m v i t a e d i e m , se, o p e r a m s a n c t i t a t e m q u e s u a m , q u a e e x iudicialibus d i s c e p t a t i o n i b u s prorsus singularis apparuit, occultare a c dissimulare n o n d e s t i t i t . Porro cur n o n e a m E c c l e s i a insigniter efferat h o n e s t e t q u e v i r g i n e m , quae, r e b u s publicis i n Gallia, saeculo x v m e x e u n t e , perturbatis, f a c t a sacerdotalis q u o d a m m o d o particeps officii, t a m flagranti E u c h a r i s t i c i c u l t u s e t decoris d o m u s D e i e x a r s i t s t u d i o , sacerdotibus e a p i e t a t i s c a r i t a t i s q u e officia c o n t i n e n t e r e x h i b u i t d e q u e s u p p l e n d a Christi m i l i t i a i t a - c o g i t a v i t c u r a v i t q u e , ut v e r e haberi possit quasi q u a e d a m p a t r o n a clero, iisque p o t i s s i m u m qui in sacri ministerii perfunctione ver- santur, d i v i n i t u s per h a n c a e t a t e m p r o p o s i t a ? E a d e m , praeterea, quis i g n o r a t q u a m b e n e d e christiana p u e l l a r u m i n s t i t u t i o n e aut per s e ipsa a u t per a l u m n a s suas m e r i t a s i t ? I t a q u e g a l l i c u m iter, dilecte f i l i N o s t e r , N o s t r a m gerens p e r s o n a m a u c t o r i t a t e m q u e praeferens N o s t r a m , libenter fidenterque suscipito; s i q u i d e m Constantienses cives ac dioecesani l a e t o gra- t o q u e P u r p u r a t u m P a t r e m e x c e p t u r i s u n t a n i m o , qui n o v u m praesentia ipsa sua afferat caritatis i n eos N o s t r a e t e s t i m o n i u m . Quo q u i d e m testi- m o n i o eos p u t a m u s dignos q u a m m a x i m e , c u m illa, q u a m Constantiensi E c c l e s i a e decessor N o s t e r B o n i f a t i u s V I I I f i d e i incorruptae s t a b i l i t a t e m e t R o m a n a e E c c l e s i a e r e v e r e n t i a m l a u d i dedit, n u n q u a m a u t decursu t e m p o r u m n u t a v e r i t a u t remiserit. A t q u e h a c ipsa a p u d N o s opinione florent dilecti o m n e s e N o r m a n n i a filii: ex illa, i n q u i m u s , regione pul- cherrima a v i t a e q u e fidei retinentissima, cui E c c l e s i a d e b e t sibi s u a e q u e gloriae p a r t o s de iis complures, quos in sanctis b e a t i s v e caelitibus h o c a n n o sacro n u m e r a v i m u s : quo loco praeterire n o l u m u s aliud Constantiae i t e m e t N o r m a n n i a e decus, P l a c i d a m Viel, Mariae M a g d a l e n a e a l u m n a m a l t e r a m q u e a b e a Congregationis s u p r e m a m A n t i s t i t a m , d e cuius sancti- t a t e et prodigiis h o c ipso die l e g i t i m e per Consilium sacris R i t i b u s prae- p o s i t u m inquiri i u s s i m u s . I a m nihil est reliquum, nisi u t , hac f a u s t a e cele- britatis occasione, Normanniae cives universi, in primisque Constan- tiensis dioecesis clerus ac populus, hortatu tuo, deprecatricem a p u d D e u m M a r i a m M a g d a l e n a m P o s t e l p r o E c c l e s i a p a t r i a e q u e suae

salute i n t e r p o n a n t . U t i n a m s a n c t a novensilis, q u e m a d m o d u m Galliam, t a m dire e o t e m p o r e t a m q u e diu e x a g i t a t a m , m i s e r a t a est, sic insigne e i d e m civilis in p a c e Christi concordiae i m p e t r e t beneficium. Caelestium interea gra- t i a r u m a u s p i c e m p a t e r n a e q u e v o l u n t a t i s N o s t r a e t e s t e m , tibi, dilecte f i l i Noster, apostolicam benedictionem peramanter impertimus.

D a t u m R o m a e a p u d s a n c t u m P e t r u m , die x x n m e n s i s iulii anno sacro MDCCCCXXV, P o n t i f i c a t u s N o s t r i quarto.

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